Lecture 21 — Exercise Selection

The DiY Programme | Module 4: Exercise Programming

Overview

Lecture 21 introduces the foundational concepts of **Exercise Selection** — the process of choosing the right exercises for a client based on their goals, training history, and progression capacity. It covers four key pillars: Assessment, Tracking Progression, Adherence, and Current Training Review.

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1. Assessment — What Does a Client Need?

Before designing any workout plan, a thorough assessment must be conducted:

- What are the client's **weak body parts**?
- What are the client's **goals**?
- Which body part needs to be **strengthened**?
- Is the goal to **boost metabolism** rather than aesthetics?

> **All these factors matter and should be taken into consideration while designing the workout plan, to know the intention of the client — whether the goal is: Aesthetics, Strength, or Health.**

Key Principle

> **"The area that needs the most improvement needs the maximum stimulus."**

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2. Training Level

Understanding where a client stands in their fitness journey is critical for appropriate programming.

Level	Definition
Beginner	Brand new to training
Novice	Progress most training loads week to week
Intermediate	Progress most training month to month
Advanced	Progression in loads over months or mesocycles

Important Notes on Training Level

- Improving your training level will give tremendous gains.
- If a person is achieving advanced gains at an intermediate level, **that doesn't mean they are advanced — that's just genetic ability.**
- **Do NOT compare yourself to anybody else. Stick to the fundamentals.**
- **➡ FOCUS ON YOURSELF.**

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3. Tracking Progression

Was the client able to make progression?

- **Week by week?** → Relevant for Beginner/Novice
- **Month by month?** → Relevant for Intermediate
- **Mesocycle by Mesocycle?** → Relevant for Advanced

Progression must be tracked at the right intervals depending on the client's training level.

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4. Training Cycles — Definitions

Understanding training cycles is essential for programming progression effectively.

Cycle	Duration	Purpose
Microcycle	~1 week	Shortest training period; plans daily workouts, exercises, intensities, and rest days
Mesocycle	Several weeks to a few months	Intermediate period; focuses on a particular aspect (strength, endurance, speed)
Macrocycle	Full year or season	Longest period; encompasses overall training year — focused on fitness, strength, or skill development

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5. Adherence

Two critical components of long-term success:

1. **Sustainability** — Can the client maintain this program over time?
2. **Enjoyment** — Does the client enjoy the training? Enjoyment drives consistency.

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6. Current Training Review

Before programming, review what the client is currently doing:

- What is their current training split?
- Are they progressing?
- Are there any imbalances or plateaus?

Key Takeaways

1. **Always ASSESS** before programming — know the client's weak points, goals, and intentions (aesthetics / strength / health).
2. **Prioritize weak areas** — the area that needs most improvement needs maximum stimulus.
3. **Know your Training Level** — Beginner → Novice → Intermediate → Advanced.
4. **Don't compare yourself** to genetically gifted people; stick to the fundamentals and focus on yourself.
5. **Track Progression** at the right time intervals — weekly, monthly, or per mesocycle depending on level.
6. **Understand your Training Cycles** — Microcycle (week) → Mesocycle (weeks/months) → Macrocycle (full year).
7. **Adherence is everything** — a sustainable and enjoyable program beats a "perfect" program you won't follow.

Source: The DiY Programme by Ekansh Taneja — Lecture 21, Module 4: Exercise Programming